# THE DECCAN & THE MUGHALS (TO 1657)

Medieval History | Topic 18 | repaired scope ends at 1657

## CENTRAL IDEA

• Mughal policy moved from embassy and pressure to foothold, coalition war, 1636 suzerainty, and renewed breach by 1657.

• Core problem: how to convert military success into durable and affordable rule in the Deccan.

## SCOPE FIREWALL

• Topic 18 owns Ahmadnagar, Chand Bibi, Malik Ambar, Jahangir-era restraint, Shah Jahan's 1636 compact, and the 1656-57 breach.

• It stops at 1657. Later Aurangzeb annexations and the mature Mughal-Maratha war belong to later topics.

## AKBAR'S OPENING

• 1591 embassies demanded Mughal supremacy; Khandesh submitted but the larger Deccan courts resisted.

• 1595-96 Ahmadnagar crisis: Chand Bibi defended Bahadur; Berar was ceded without ending resistance.

• 1600 Ahmadnagar fort and 1601 Asirgarh/Khandesh gave a foothold, not full countryside control.

## MALIK AMBAR AND THE FIELD WAR

• Habshi-origin statesman who rebuilt Nizam Shahi resistance through claimant legitimacy, cavalry mobility, and supply-line pressure.

• His coalition politics, local intelligence, and revenue reconstruction showed why fort conquest alone was insufficient.

## JAHANGIR PHASE

• 1611 exposed divided Mughal command.

• 1616-17 and 1621 restored leverage, but restraint remained: recovery did not become blanket annexation.

• 1624 Bhaturi marked Malik Ambar's late operational high point.

## SHAH JAHAN AND 1636

• Khan-i-Jahan Lodi's asylum and continuing instability hardened policy against Ahmadnagar.

• 1633 Daulatabad fell and the ruling Nizam Shahi line ended, though Shahji prolonged claimant resistance.

• 1636 settlements placed Bijapur and Golconda under coercive Mughal suzerainty while preserving them as buffer states.

## 1652-57 BREACH

• Aurangzeb's second viceroyalty faced deficit strain and weak realization.

• Mir Jumla's rupture with Golconda and the Bijapur succession crisis reopened intervention.

• By 1657 the spirit of 1636 was already fraying, but the story stops before the later annexation wars.

## PRELIMS AND MAINS ANCHORS

• 1636 did not annex Bijapur or Golconda.

• Malik Ambar died in 1626; one OCR strand prints 1627.

• Best mains line: Mughal success in the Deccan was real, but durable control remained conditional, expensive, and incomplete by 1657.